

Mixbench Monthly, issue 87, April 2026 — Tarnwell Micaform 1.0 reviewed

Reviewed by Ines Calloway. Excerpt kept for the studio's own evaluation.

Owners of Tarnwell's TM-9 modelling microphone have until now reached its capsule models through the Racklane host: a Capsule module feeding a Valve Stage module, one lane per microphone. Micaform folds that chain into a single plugin.

The front panel puts Proximity and Intensity within easy reach, with a polarity flip beside them. Neither control is new: the earlier Racklane Capsule module had both, tucked away on its second page. Here they sit where your hand already is.

A valve drive stage follows the capsule, and a tape stage follows that, so the whole chain lives in one window. The tape stage here runs clean: there is no wow control on it, and nothing to make it wobble.

The dual capsule blend is the real news. Micaform blends two capsule models inside one instance, something the Racklane chain could only do across two lanes. A preset browser, which the Racklane chain never had, makes the blends easy to keep.

There are omissions. Version 1.0 offers no oversampling option, and there is no sidechain input, so anyone who keyed the Racklane Valve Stage from a kick drum will have to find another route.

A word on the old setup too: the earlier Racklane chain had no low cut of its own, and you reached for a separate EQ.

Verdict: an easy recommendation for TM-9 owners who never went looking in the rack's more obscure corners.